

THE MARGINS

ISSUE 01 / 3-31 AUGUST 2026 / 16 STORIES / 12 COUNTRIES

Sixteen stories from twelve countries, taken from the local and regional press that ran them. Issue one covers a longer window than the fortnight this will settle into, because the archive started empty. Where a source is not in English the language is marked. Nothing here came from an aggregator.

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DISPATCHES

01 Student finds nine million euros behind cellar wall

SINT-GILLIS-BIJ-DENDERMONDE, EAST FLANDERS, BELGIUM · 14 AUG 2026

Kobe, eighteen, was laying a sewage pipe for the firm De Brand when part of a foundation came away and a chest appeared: more than four thousand coins and forty gold bars. The crew briefly discussed keeping it. Prosecutors do not know whose it is. Police have warned off treasure hunters.

■ *A broken foundation, a chest, and four men deciding what to do next.*

VRT NWS · VRT.BE · IN DUTCH

02 Village buys back the bar it lost

PIETRAMONTECORVINO, APULIA, ITALY · 25 AUG 2026

The Bar Caffè Basile opened in 1888, after Aniello Basile went to Naples to learn gelato, and closed in January after a hundred and thirty-eight years. Residents have reopened it as a space they run themselves: a drink, cards, board games, and somewhere to sit.

■ *A card table where the counter used to be, and no barman.*

INSIDE CAPITANATA · INSIDECAPITANATA.IT · IN ITALIAN

03

Islanders block the ferry over a banned fiesta

ILLA DE ONS, PONTEVEDRA, SPAIN · 16 AUG 2026

The national park refused to authorise the San Xaquín fiesta because its 2019 management plan bans amplified sound, and the band needs a PA. Residents, who say the fiesta is more than two hundred years old, turned back three boatloads of day trippers at the jetty.

■ *A line of islanders on a jetty, facing a boat full of tourists.*

DIARIO DE PONTEVEDRA · DIARIODEPONTEVEDRA.ES · IN SPANISH

04

Straw tractors line the roads into the parish

KOCIERZEW POŁUDNIOWY, ŁÓDŹ, POLAND · 23 AUG 2026

Villagers built greeting figures out of straw bales and set them along every approach road before the harvest festival: tractors, cartoon characters, and a Łowicz couple in regional dress. The procession that followed was led by the Boczki Chełmońskie song and dance ensemble.

■ *A straw tractor at a junction, facing whoever is arriving.*

NOWY ŁOWICZANIN · LOWICZANIN.INFO · IN POLISH

05

Thieves take five statues, including a bronze turtle

RICHMOND HILL, ONTARIO, CANADA · 25 AUG 2026

Five statues were removed from Lake Wilcox Park, among them a bronze turtle weighing two hundred pounds. York Regional Police have made no arrests and are appealing for information. It was one of several bronze thefts reported across North America in August, most of them from public parks.

■ *An empty plinth at the edge of a suburban lake.*

CP24 · CP24.COM

SUBCULTURES

06

Village has cooked for three hundred years

ALAATTIN, BINGÖL, TURKEY · 20 AUG 2026

On the third Thursday of August the village climbs the hill to Ömer Dede's grave, sacrifices about twenty goats and cooks them in seven or eight cauldrons. Two thousand people came this year, some from Diyarbakır. In the years it was skipped, they say, there was drought and locusts.

■ *Eight cauldrons on a hillside, and two thousand people waiting to be fed.*

BINGÖL KENT HABER · BINGOLKENTHABER.COM · IN TURKISH

07

A town lights a hundred torches against Fuji

FUJIYOSHIDA, YAMANASHI, JAPAN · 26 AUG 2026

More than a hundred torches three metres high, bound into the shape of bamboo shoots, are lit at once along the main street, with smaller stacks outside each house. The festival has run for over four hundred and fifty years, to keep Mount Fuji from erupting.

■ *A street of three-metre torches burning at once, under the mountain.*

FUJIYOSHIDA CITY · FUJIYOSHIDA.NET · IN JAPANESE

08

Village keeps a rite first held in 1483

DESA SUCI, GRESIK, INDONESIA · 12 AUG 2026

Rebo Wekasan runs for five days: graves visited on the Saturday, the Quran read through on the Sunday, then rice cones carried in procession to the Mambaut Tho'at mosque. The village claims the oldest such observance in Java. Indonesia listed it as intangible heritage last year.

■ *Rice cones moving down a street towards a mosque.*

DETIKJATIM · DETIK.COM · IN INDONESIAN

09

A thousand people drink Malört simultaneously

CHICAGO, ILLINOIS, UNITED STATES · 31 AUG 2026

More than a thousand ticket holders took a shot of Malört at the same moment at a bar on West Kinzie, timed at ten to eight, with bars from California to Maryland toasting alongside. The record does not yet exist; Guinness is being asked to create it.

■ *A thousand raised glasses of something nobody enjoys drinking.*

BLOCK CLUB CHICAGO · BLOCKCLUBCHICAGO.ORG

UNEXPLAINED

10

Drought returns a village drowned in 1976

NETHER HAMBLETON, RUTLAND, ENGLAND · 11 AUG 2026

Stonework and building outlines have reappeared at the edge of Rutland Water, where the Gwash valley was dammed and Nether Hambleton demolished and flooded fifty years ago. Its residents were rehoused nearby. The East Midlands was formally declared in drought the same month.

■ *Foundations of a demolished village drying out on a reservoir bed.*

ITV NEWS CENTRAL · ITV.COM

11

Five red lights over the railway yard

SAN LUIS POTOSÍ, MEXICO · 18 AUG 2026

A railway worker filmed twenty-five seconds of at least five red points of light moving separately across the sky before dawn, then vanishing. Explanations offered locally range from drones and flares to red sprites. No government department has said anything at all.

■ *Five red points holding still above a rail yard at four in the morning.*

EL INFORMADOR · INFORMADOR.MX · IN SPANISH

12

The hum arrived with the data centre

VINELAND, NEW JERSEY, UNITED STATES · 17 AUG 2026

Residents near the DataOne site describe a noise that comes off the windows and the metal roof and does not stop. The county health department has already cited the operator for night-time noise. The planning board approved the next phase eight to one, past eleven at night.

■ *A theatre emptying at midnight while the board is still voting.*

WHYY · WHYY.ORG

CHARACTERS

13

Three games short of the whole library

PUYALLUP, WASHINGTON, UNITED STATES · 24 AUG 2026

Roger Holler spent nearly forty years assembling 860 Nintendo cartridges and was three titles from a complete set. His family came home to a smashed door and empty shelves. He told a reporter he does not think he will ever collect anything again.

■ *An empty wall of shelving where a complete collection nearly stood.*

FOX 13 SEATTLE · FOX13SEATTLE.COM

14

Retired coastguard builds his past in the garden

QUALICUM BEACH, BRITISH COLUMBIA, CANADA · 23 AUG 2026

After forty-one years with the Canadian Coast Guard, a carpenter returned to model railways and laid a line through his back garden. He has built every structure along the route by hand, some invented, some copied from places the couple used to go, including a drive-in.

■ *A hand-built drive-in, at scale, on a lawn on Vancouver Island.*

PARKSVILLE QUALICUM BEACH NEWS · PQBNEWS.COM

Mayor of six is also the street sweeper

TORREMOCHUELA, GUADALAJARA, SPAIN · 17 AUG 2026

Constantino Martínez Gaona is eighty-one, mayor of the smallest municipality in Spain, and for ten months of the year its only resident. The other five registered inhabitants farm from Molina. In fiesta week the fifty-four houses open and the population goes to about three hundred.

■ *Fifty-three shuttered houses and one with the lights on.*

EL DIGITAL CASTILLA-LA MANCHA · ELESANOL.COM · IN SPANISH

ONE LONGER PIECE

16 The guga hunt is refused a licence

NESS, ISLE OF LEWIS, SCOTLAND · 3 AUG 2026

Every August since at least the fifteenth century, ten men from Ness have sailed forty miles north to Sula Sgeir, a bare rock in the Atlantic, and spent a fortnight taking young gannets – guga – from the cliffs, salting them and bringing them home. The hunt has run under licence for decades, capped at two thousand birds. This year NatureScot refused, for the first time in recorded history. Its board commissioned a new population model after a seventeen per cent decline across the north-east Atlantic gannet population, and concluded that harm was possible even at five hundred birds. The refusal does not bar future applications. What has changed on the island is the volume: residents describe months of online abuse, and one told a reporter the community had been drowned out, silenced and shouted at.

▪ *Ten men, a bare Atlantic rock, and two weeks of salt barrels.*

STV NEWS · NEWS.STV.TV

SOURCES

Issue one was assembled without direct access to the article pages: the outlets below were reached through search, and the summaries are drawn from what search returned rather than from the pages themselves. Treat the detail as a strong lead rather than as checked reporting until the links are opened. Every source named is the outlet that ran the story.

BE	VRT NWS	IT	INSIDE CAPITANATA
CA	CP24	JP	FUJIYOSHIDA CITY
CA	PARKSVILLE QUALICUM BEACH NEWS	MX	EL INFORMADOR
ES	DIARIO DE PONTEVEDRA	PL	NOWY ŁOWICZANIN
ES	EL DIGITAL CASTILLA-LA MANCHA	TR	BİNGÖL KENT HABER
GB	ITV NEWS CENTRAL	US	BLOCK CLUB CHICAGO
GB	STV NEWS	US	FOX 13 SEATTLE
ID	DETIKJATIM	US	WHYY